

You never know what the opportunity might be, but it will present itself. Ted Turner was absolutely correct when, in response to a question about how to make a fortune, he answered that you should go to where the action is and throw yourself in the middle of it. The law of large numbers will work, and some of the wealth will start coming your way.

If I were 18 or 21 again, what I would do is get *some* money—borrowed from grandmother, saved from mowing lawns, withdrawn from the college fund, raised selling possessions, whatever—and use that grubstake as seed money.

You have to start someplace. Most people could learn something from the average Chinese. As a culture, they've really been through the meat grinder over the last century, and know how important it is to save.

Anyway, I would take that grubstake and hit the road and go someplace new, as different as you can get from wherever you start. That way you're new, fresh, unique. If you're American and you stay in the U.S. where there are masses of people just like you, no one has any special reason to hire you; you are—at least at first blush—just one of millions with similar backgrounds. Better to go to Honduras or Bolivia or Laos or Nigeria, where you'll stand out from the crowd and have something to contribute that others do not.

You're interesting—and that opens up opportunities. And how interesting you are is a function of how many books you've read, how much thought you've put into things, how widely you've traveled, how many skills you've mastered, how many people you know. It's completely up to you. But you've got to get out of your comfortable and safe-seeming hometown—otherwise you're no better than a medieval peasant, chained to the dirt his ancestors toiled over and were buried in, for generations. Your chances of getting anywhere that way are slim and none.¹

The important thing to remember is that you have to think like an outsider, not an insider. Insiders make money by succeeding in existing organizations. They can be very important, very competent, very hardworking, and very well paid. But it's very hard to build a fortune as an insider.